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AFIS AT AERODROMES

Air traffic service plays a crucial role in ensuring the safe and organized movement of aircraft at an aerodrome or within a specific airspace. The service ensures an equitable level of protection for the aircraft and effective management of orderly air traffic operations. Air Traffic Control Service is provided at controlled aerodromes; Aerodrome Flight Information Service, or AFIS, is provided for non-controlled aerodromes where the type and density of air traffic do not necessitate Air Traffic Control Service.

AFIS shall be an important consideration for non-controlled aerodromes where commercial air transport aircraft operate. Commercial air transport carrying 'paying-passengers' warrants some form of air traffic service that assures flight safety and efficiency. AFIS furnishes air traffic at a non-controlled aerodrome with essential aerodrome operational information such as current weather, and facilitates the provision of alerting service.

Some aerodromes used by commercial air transport aircraft do not have air traffic service; neither Air Traffic Control Service nor Aerodrome Flight Information Service is available. Most are non-controlled aerodromes that are located in uncontrolled airspace. Flights operating to and from these non-controlled aerodromes merely receive flight information services from a remote air traffic service unit not stationed at the aerodrome itself. However, remote air traffic service only provides limited information about other known traffic that an aircraft may need to avoid. A remote air traffic service unit cannot provide current information on weather conditions at an aerodrome or the aerodrome's operational status, both of which are significant for ensuring safe and efficient aircraft operations.

AFIS is not an Air Traffic Control service. AFIS at a non-controlled aerodrome does not necessarily require an Air Traffic Controller. Instead, a trained and qualified Aerodrome Flight Information Service Officer, authorized by the civil aviation authority, is stationed at a non-controlled aerodrome to deliver this service.

Civil Aviation Directive 1102 outlines the requirements and procedures related to the Aerodrome Flight Information Service.

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